sunnah.com/bukhari/25 (*Sahih* Book 25, "Kitab al-Hajj") and https://sunnah.com/bukhari/30: (*Sahih* Book 25, "Kitab al-Saum"). See also Appendix, Afghanistan IV: 3.

47. According to Najimi 2015: 163 (Appendix, Afghanistan IV: 9); but see *infra* in main text.
48. Blair (1998: 69) claimed that verses from Surat al-Fath were common on mosques, though evidently this assessment applied *outside* the eastern Islamic lands: Blair (1992) did not document a single occurrence on *any* building type through AH 500/1106 CE. However, at Barsiyan within the Isfahan oasis, Q. XLVIII: 1–5 appeared at the base of the dome of the complex's mosque – a complex including a *minar* and possibly a caravanserai; the mosque was dated by inscription to AH 528/1134 CE (about thirty-six years *after* the *minar*'s inscribed date of AH 491/1097–1098 CE) (cf. Godard and Smith 1937: 40–41). Finally, late eleventh- and twelfth-century quotations of the Sura's verses (Q. XLVIII: 1–5) come from Cairo, namely, at Mashhad al-Juyushi dating to AH 477/1085 CE; and a century later at the adjacent, "magnificent Citadel" (Ar. *qal'a*) of Cairo (Q. XLVIII: 1–3), initiated by the renowned Salah al-Din in AH 578/1183–1184 CE. Cf. *RCEA*, vol. 9 (1937) No. 3380; and Rabbat 1995: 68–73. Upon this first citation of the *RCEA*, we should bear in mind early critiques of this monumental project even by one of its editors, J. Sourdel-Thomine (1976: 265), who questioned "the role to be played … of a tool [whose] conception was already old [i.e., obsolete]." Hillenbrand (2012: 19) specified the *RCEA*'s in-built obsolescence and its consequences: "Strange as it may seem, Quranic inscriptions are recorded in this vast opus only when, as part of the same inscription, historical matter is included." Such is the case with the aforementioned Barsiyan complex, whose dome and *mihrab* inscriptions were not noted in *RCEA* – despite the latter's mention of a date (cf. also Kalus, *TEI* fiche No. 37215; Godard and Smith cited *supra*). It is possible, then, that important instances of Qur'anic citation may not factor into scholarly analyses simply because they do not appear in the *RCEA.* Cf. also Appendix.
49. All identified Shansabani-patronized epigraphy is in Arabic, with the exception of the Persian date of Chisht's southwestern structure (discussed *infra* in main text; Appendix, Afghanistan III: 5d). This overall trend is at variance with Ghaznavid and Qarakhanid epigraphic *corpora*, wherein Persian was increasingly used particularly as a language of architectural inscriptions, beginning in the early eleventh century and onward. Cf. Hillenbrand 2012: 21ff.; esp. Allegranzi 2015: 34 and *passim*; Allegranzi 2019a, vol. I: 47ff.
50. The actual readability of monumental epigraphy in pre-modern times has long been discussed in scholarship, beginning with Ettinghausen (1974). Scholarly consensus has stressed that "Islamic inscriptions were not expected to be read in this literal sense but rather functioned in an imagistic or symbolic manner, affirming the belief of the patron as well as that of the viewer" (Edwards 1991: 65). See also Thomas 2012: 145–146, 156–158.
51. It is more than likely that, well into the mid-twelfth century, the Firuzkuh Shansabanis also maintained some aspects of non-Islamic religious practices. Cf. Chapter 3 for Tiginabad/Old Qandahar in the plains of al-Rukkhaj,